



Slower Isn't Seen

A lobby signage screen's dwell-time sensor, tested against what passersby actually recall

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Background

After regulators pressed platforms to slow autoplay and cap infinite scroll, the lobby's own signage screen adopted a matching rotation cap on anticipated-compliance grounds. Its dwell-time sensor justified the change. Does a longer sensor read mean anyone actually remembers what was on screen?

Aims

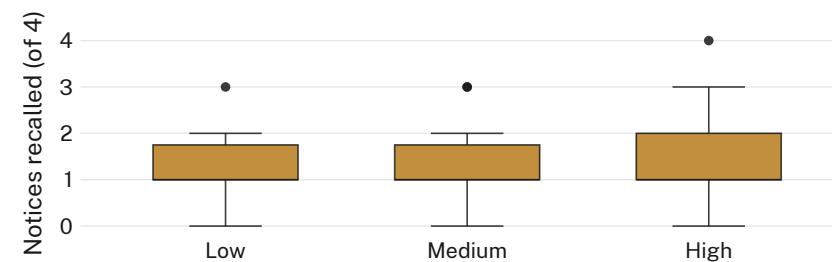
- Test whether the sensor's dwell-time tier predicts passerby recall
- Compare recall before and after the rotation-speed cap took effect
- Check whether the cap's anticipated-compliance rationale was ever tested against an outcome

Methods

- n = 214 unannounced recall quizzes · 4 rotating notices · 9 weeks
- Dwell-time sensor (Wi-Fi probe lingering proxy) binned Low / Medium / High
- Quiz wording and recall threshold pre-registered; rotation cap (8s → 20s per slide) held unchanged post hoc

Results

Median recall holds at one of four notices across all three dwell-time tiers and across the rotation-speed change. The sensor's read and a passerby's memory of the screen move independently.



214 unannounced recall quizzes, weeks 1–9: median recall is one of four notices in the Low, Medium, and High dwell-time tiers alike, unchanged after the rotation cap took effect in week 5.

Discussion & conclusions

The dwell-time sensor reads what lingers near the screen, not what a passerby carries away from it. The rotation cap it justified proceeds under an anticipated-compliance banner no one has since revisited. Next: whether the sensor's read correlates with anything at all.

References

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3. Vega-Barbas, M., Álvarez-Campana, M., Rivera, D., Sanz, M., & Berrocal, J. (2021). AFOROS: a low-cost Wi-Fi-based monitoring system for estimating occupancy of public spaces. *Sensors*, 21(11), 3863. doi:10.3390/s21113863
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De-identified quiz responses only; sensor logs held on the School's existing Indicator Commons infrastructure. No dwell-time threshold was revised after the results came in.

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“Nobody looked up. The sensor logged it anyway.”

Recall holds flat across all three dwell-time tiers, n = 214, weeks 1–9